

Figure 1: Add Gnome2 Menu Bar to panel

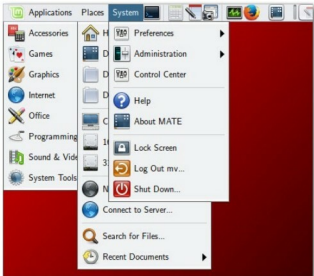


Figure 2: Gnome 2 menu

User accounts

The default account in Mint/Ubuntu is an administrator account. Even though admin permissions are available only with `sudo`, it is best to create a 'desktop' account for the user. Tell the user to log in to the default account only for troubleshooting. You can also tell the user that for simple admin tasks, the admin shell can be accessed by typing `su [default-account-username]`.

Software repositories

After the OS is installed and updated, you may have to install proprietary drivers for the graphics card. After that, you should install regular software packages that will be useful.

```
sudo apt-get install artha ark clamtk mirage inkscape arista
audacious easytag ripperx winff bluefish rapidsvn meld
dosemu wine samba smbclient wddial gnome-ppp
```

The Samba client package adds support for Windows shares in the Caja file manager. In most cases, LAN locations of other computers and devices can be accessed using addresses in the

format `smb://192.168.x.x/share_name/directory_path`.

If the user would like to share local directories with DNLA media devices (PlayStation or WD TV), then type `sudo apt get install ushare` to install `ushare`. The command `ushare -c path-to-shared-directory` will turn the specified directory into a DNLA media server share.

Introduce the new users to the Software Manager or Software Center app in the distro so that they can explore and install applications on their own.

And just to demonstrate how powerful FOSS can be, open GIMP and show users how to add filters such as drop shadows to an image.

FFmpeg

With the proliferation of devices such as smartphones and digital cameras, almost everyone needs to work with a wide variety of audio and media file formats. FFmpeg can be used to convert media files from one format to another. Because many of these formats are encumbered by 'software patents', the default ISO installation may not add the necessary codecs to play many popular formats.

The FFmpeg website has a page with steps for manually compiling and installing FFmpeg from source. Follow these steps and FFmpeg binary files will be created in a directory named 'bin' in the user's 'home' directory. Copy these files to `/usr/bin` directory.

After this, FFmpeg will be available for a variety of programs, such as Arista Transcoder, RipperX (for audio CDs), Pitivi and WinFF.

To list all codecs supported by that FFmpeg installation, type the command `ffmpeg -codecs` in a terminal. It will give you an idea of what sort of conversions are possible. Here are a couple of examples of FFmpeg-based media file conversion:

```
ffmpeg -i tank.flv -f mp4 tank.mp4 # converts tank.flv to MP4
format
ffmpeg -i tank.flv -vn -f mp3 tank.mp3 # removes video stream to
create an audio file
```



Figure 3: Software Manager